

Blake Hoarty

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC	2027 (Expected)
- Dissertation: "Essays on Subjective Probability and Bayesian Inference in Agricultural Economics" - Committee: Profs. Jeffrey H. Dorfman, Barry Goodwin, Nicholas Piggott, Sujit Ghosh	
M.A. in Economics, George Mason University, Fairfax, VA	2020
B.A. in Public Policy & Political Science, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, NC	2016

RESEARCH FIELDS

Agricultural Economics, Bayesian Econometrics, Microeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

"A Sequential Stochastic Approach to Rationalizing Hedging Decisions in Agricultural Markets," with Jeffrey H. Dorfman

- Abstract:** Farmers have historically exhibited a tremendous amount of heterogeneity in their hedging patterns. Previous research has mostly modeled farmer behavior by employing the mean-variance hedge ratio in a 2-period investment setting. In this paper, we eschew this approach and argue that the timing of the hedge matters just as much, if not more, than the terminal hedge ratio. We use expected utility theory to rationalize hedging decisions made by farmers in a dynamic setting. We enable our farmer to make hedging decisions on a weekly basis to account for incremental changes in prior market beliefs. We find that subjective prior beliefs and crop insurance coverage play a significant role in hedging decisions. Other factors such as initial wealth play a small but non-negligible role in guiding hedging decisions. Our results indicate that only pessimistic farmers hedge in concordance with traditional financial wisdom. We also find that unbiased farmers, regardless of the degree of risk aversion, forego hedging until late in the harvesting season.

PUBLICATIONS

"PPI and CPI seasonal adjustment during the COVID-19 pandemic," with Steven Muri et al., **Monthly Labor Review**, U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, (May 2022)

"On regulation and excess reserves: The case of Basel III" with Stephen M. Miller, **Journal of Financial Research** (Vol. 44, No. 2), pp. 215-247 (March 2021)

"Who Participates? An Analysis of School Participation Decisions in Two Voucher Programs in the United States," with Corey Deangelis, **Cato Institute Policy Analysis no. 848**, (September 2018)

EXTENSION PUBLICATIONS

"Is There a Future for Tobacco Farming?" with Jeffrey H. Dorfman & Younghyeon Jeon, **Southern Ag Today** 6(24.1), (June 2026)

WORKING PAPERS

"The Evolving Nature of Seasonality in Meat Demand," with Barry Goodwin & Jeffrey H. Dorfman

"Moment Based Prior Sensitivity Analysis in High Dimensional Bayesian Econometric Models," with Jeffrey H. Dorfman & Sujit Ghosh

"Optimally Combining Information Sources to Estimate the Federal Poverty Guidelines: Robustness and Red Flags," with Jeffrey H. Dorfman et al.

PRESENTATIONS

Southern Economic Association (Houston, TX)	2026
• "Moment Based Prior Sensitivity Analysis in High Dimensional Bayesian Econometric Models"	
AAEA Annual Meeting (Kansas City, MO)	2026
• Accepted Poster: "A Sequential Stochastic Approach to Rationalizing Hedging Decisions in Agricultural Markets," • Accepted Poster: "The Evolving Nature of Seasonality in Meat Demand" • Accepted Presentation: "Optimally Combining Information Sources to Estimate the Federal Poverty Guidelines: Robustness and Red Flags,"	
American Statistical Association's 4th Seasonal Adjustment Practitioners' Workshop (Online)	2022
• "PPI and CPI seasonal adjustment during the COVID-19 pandemic,"	
Western Economic Association (San Francisco, CA)	2019
• "On regulation and excess reserves: The case of Basel III"	

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant - Barry Goodwin, North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC	2026 – present
Research Assistant - Jeffrey H. Dorfman, North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC	2024 – 2026
Economist - Consumer Price Index, U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Washington, DC	2020 – 2022
MA Fellow, Mercatus Center at George Mason University, Arlington, VA	2018 – 2020
Research Assistant, Cato Institute, Washington, DC	2017 – 2018
Research Intern, Cato Institute, Washington, DC	2017

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Independent Instructor of Record, NC State University	2024 – Present
• EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics: Fall 2026 • EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics: Spring 2026 * Average course evaluation score across all questions: 4.76/5 (N = 25) • ARE 201: Introduction to Agricultural and Resource Economics: Spring 2025 * Average course evaluation score across all questions: 4.48/5 (N = 28) • EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics: Spring 2024 * Average course evaluation score across all questions: 4.79/5 (N = 15)	
Graduate Teaching Assistant, NC State University	2022 – 2024
• EC 201: Principles of Microeconomics: Fall 2024 • EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics: Fall 2023 • EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics: Spring 2023 • EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics: Fall 2022	

FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS AND GRANTS

University Graduate Fellowship, NC State University	2022, 2023
MA Fellowship, George Mason University	2018-2020

OTHER INFORMATION

Programming: MATLAB, R, Stata, SAS

REFERENCES

Prof. Jeffrey H. Dorfman (Advisor)
Hugh C. Kiger Distinguished Professor
Dept. of Agricultural & Resource Economics
NC State University, Raleigh, NC
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Prof. Nicholas Piggott
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